Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠10

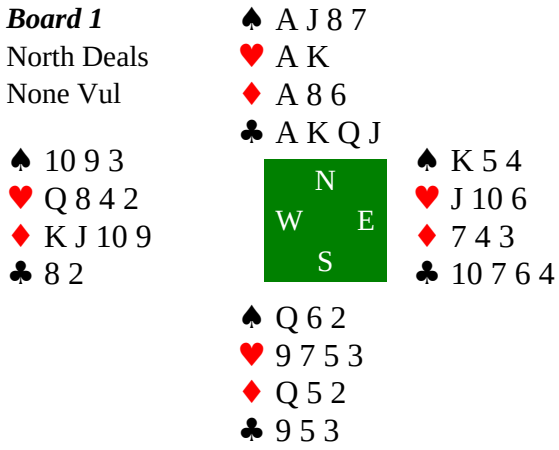
Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠J

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 7♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥3

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♥J

NORTH has lots of points - 26 to be exact. She opens 2♣. In the old days this hand would have been opened 3NT.

SOUTH has 4 points and responds 2♦.

NORTH now shows her full strength by jumping to 3NT (25-27 points, balanced).

SOUTH knows there is no slam, so he passes 3NT.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K J
♥ J 10
♦ A Q 9 4
♣ J 10 9 7 2

♠ 6 4 2
♥ 7 5 4
♦ J 7 2
♣ 8 6 5 3



♠ A 7 3
♥ A K Q 8 6 2
♦ 8 6
♣ A K

♠ Q 10 9 8 5
♥ 9 3
♦ K 10 5 3
♣ Q 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♥	
All Pass			

3♥ by East
Lead: ♠10

EAST has 22 points and opens 2♣.

WEST is pretty weak, right? She responds 2♦.

EAST bids his suit, 2♥.

WEST is so weak she bids the second negative - 3♣.

EAST rebids his suit, 3♥, and WEST passes.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 6 3
♥ A K 8 2
♦ K Q J
♣ K Q

♠ J 10 8 7
♥ 10 4
♦ 9 6 4 3
♣ 8 6 4



♠ Q 9 5
♥ 6 3
♦ 10 8 7
♣ A J 10 9 2

♠ 4 2
♥ Q J 9 7 5
♦ A 5 2
♣ 7 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠J

NORTH has a nice 2♣ opening hand.

With 8 points, SOUTH can make a positive response so he bids his 5-card ♥suit.

NORTH likes ♥s, knows there are at least 33 points, but needs to make sure the opponents don't have two Aces so she uses Blackwood.

When SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH bids 6♥.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 6 5 ♥ 9 6 3 ♦ Q J 10 7 5 ♣ J 3 2	
♠ A J 9 8 3 ♥ K 7 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A 8 7 4		♠ K Q 10 2 ♥ A Q J 10 5 ♦ A K 2 ♣ K
	♠ 7 4 ♥ 8 4 ♦ 9 8 4 3 ♣ Q 10 9 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]	Pass
7♠			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces

7♠ by West
Lead: ♥3

EAST opens 2♣ and is pleased when WEST makes a positive response of 2♠. His first step is to set the trump suit by bidding 3♠. There is NO chance that WEST will pass.

WEST now bids 4♣ a Control-showing bid. EAST continues Control-showing with 4♦.

That's enough for WEST to hear. She invokes Blackwood and learning they have all the Aces bids 7♠.